

GED Social Studies Practice Test 5

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC5-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state plans to redraw legislative district boundaries after a population count. The state holds public hearings and publishes proposed district maps before voting on the final plan. Residents argue that districts should have roughly equal populations so that each person's vote carries similar weight.

Which civic principle is most directly connected to this concern?

- A) Equal representation
- B) Executive privilege
- C) Military command
- D) Naturalization

GED-SOC5-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A bakery tracks how many loaves of bread suppliers are willing to provide at different prices.

Price per loaf: \$2, \$3, \$4

Loaves supplied per day: 180, 260, 360

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Suppliers offered more loaves as the price increased.
- B) Suppliers offered fewer loaves as the price increased.
- C) The supply of bread stayed the same at every price.
- D) Price had no connection to the amount supplied.

GED-SOC5-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the decades before the Civil War, abolitionists published newspapers, organized meetings, and sent petitions to Congress demanding an end to slavery. Opponents of abolition sometimes tried to prevent these materials from being distributed or discussed. The conflict showed how debates over slavery also involved arguments about speech, petition, and political participation.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) The slavery debate also raised questions about civil liberties and political expression.
- B) Abolitionists avoided using public communication.
- C) Congress had no connection to petitions before the Civil War.
- D) Opposition to slavery ended sectional conflict immediately.

GED-SOC5-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A highland region has cool temperatures, steep slopes, and limited flat farmland. Many communities grow crops on terraces and raise animals adapted to mountain conditions. Roads are difficult to build, so trade often depends on narrow passes through the mountains.

Which statement best explains how geography shapes life in this region?

- A) Mountain environments affect farming, transportation, and trade.
- B) Highlands always prevent any human settlement.
- C) Cool temperatures make transportation unnecessary.
- D) Terraces are used mainly in flat desert regions.

GED-SOC5-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A county commission is deciding whether to issue bonds to build a new water treatment plant. Residents attend hearings, ask questions about the cost, and submit comments about water quality and future taxes.

Which TWO statements best describe the civic process shown?

- A) Residents are providing input before a public spending decision.
- B) Public hearings can help officials learn community concerns.
- C) The commission is declaring war under federal authority.
- D) Residents are replacing courts with private businesses.
- E) Tax decisions never involve public debate.

GED-SOC5-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A state election official argues that voter identification rules protect election integrity. The official

says voters must be confident that each ballot is cast by an eligible person. The official also says the state provides free identification cards for voters who need them.

Source B:

A community organizer argues that identification rules can make voting harder for people who do not drive, move often, or have difficulty getting documents. The organizer says election rules should prevent fraud without creating unnecessary barriers for eligible voters.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether election rules should balance security with access to voting
- B) Whether elections should be held every year for every office
- C) Whether courts should count ballots by hand in every precinct
- D) Whether state governments should stop holding elections

GED-SOC5-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

At the end of the 1800s, some Americans argued that the United States should acquire overseas territories to gain markets, naval bases, and international influence. Others warned that ruling people without their full consent conflicted with American democratic ideals.

Which historical debate is described in the source?

- A) Debate over U.S. imperialism and overseas expansion
- B) Debate over building the first colonial settlements
- C) Debate over whether the Constitution should include a Bill of Rights
- D) Debate over creating the first national bank

GED-SOC5-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

In a criminal case, the government must prove guilt [D1], and the accused has the right to [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) beyond a reasonable doubt | by popular vote | through a tax assessment

D2) legal counsel | command the military | ratify amendments

GED-SOC5-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A worker's hourly wage increased from \$16 to \$20. What was the percent increase?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC5-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A coastal country builds several large ports and invests in container shipping. Over the next decade, manufacturing exports rise, and more workers move to port cities for jobs connected to shipping, warehousing, and trade.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Access to transportation networks can influence economic growth and migration.
- B) Ports prevent cities from developing near the coast.
- C) International trade always reduces manufacturing employment.
- D) People move only because of climate, not jobs.

GED-SOC5-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

Congress passes a law creating a new consumer protection agency. The agency writes rules, investigates complaints, and enforces penalties authorized by Congress. Courts may review whether the agency follows the law when it acts.

Which statement best explains this arrangement?

- A) Administrative agencies can carry out laws, but their actions remain subject to legal limits.
- B) Agencies replace Congress and courts entirely.
- C) Agencies may punish people without any authority from law.
- D) Courts are forbidden from reviewing agency decisions.

GED-SOC5-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows production of military aircraft during a national mobilization.

Year: 1940, 1942, 1944

Aircraft produced: 6,000, 47,000, 96,000

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Aircraft production expanded sharply between 1940 and 1944.
- B) Aircraft production decreased after 1940.
- C) Aircraft production was highest in 1940.
- D) The number of aircraft produced stayed constant.

GED-SOC5-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state takes part of a privately owned lot to widen a dangerous road. The owner challenges the action. The court says government may take private property for public use only if it follows legal procedures and provides fair payment.

Which constitutional principle is involved?

- A) Eminent domain with just compensation
- B) Freedom from quartering soldiers
- C) Presidential appointment power
- D) State power to coin money

GED-SOC5-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A city gives a tax credit to companies that install energy-efficient equipment. Several companies decide to upgrade older machines because the credit lowers the total cost of the project.

Which economic idea is best illustrated?

- A) Incentives can influence business decisions.
- B) Businesses never respond to changes in cost.
- C) Tax policy cannot affect private investment.
- D) Opportunity cost disappears when government offers a credit.

GED-SOC5-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution says that no person may be punished by a law that makes an action illegal only after the person has already done it. Supporters say this prevents government from changing the rules after the fact to punish a specific behavior.

Which protection is described?

- A) Protection against ex post facto laws
- B) Right to vote by mail
- C) Power of judicial appointment
- D) Protection of state trade barriers

GED-SOC5-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During the 1930s, drought, soil erosion, and falling crop prices forced many farm families to leave parts of the Great Plains. Some traveled west looking for agricultural or industrial work, but they often faced poverty, discrimination, and unstable employment.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Environmental and economic pressures contributed to migration.
- B) Migrants always found secure employment immediately.
- C) The crisis affected both where people lived and how they worked.
- D) Drought eliminated all farming in the United States.
- E) Migration during the period had no connection to economic hardship.

GED-SOC5-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region reports sources of electricity generation.

Source: Natural gas, Hydropower, Wind, Coal

Share of electricity: 42%, 28%, 18%, 12%

Which source provides the second-largest share of electricity?

- A) Natural gas
- B) Hydropower
- C) Wind
- D) Coal

GED-SOC5-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A federal law requires agencies to give the public access to many government records. A journalist uses the law to request spending data from an agency and then writes an article explaining how funds were used.

Which democratic value is most directly supported by this process?

- A) Public accountability through access to information
- B) Secret lawmaking by unelected officials
- C) Military control of public records
- D) Hereditary selection of agency leaders

GED-SOC5-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A town reports the following annual tourism revenue.

Year: 2021, 2022, 2023

Tourism revenue: \$3.2 million, \$3.8 million, \$4.5 million

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Tourism revenue increased each year.
- B) Tourism revenue decreased each year.
- C) Tourism revenue was the same in 2021 and 2023.
- D) Tourism revenue was lowest in 2023.

GED-SOC5-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The Supreme Court decision in *Brown v. Board of Education* challenged [D1] in public schools and became part of the broader [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) racial segregation | protective tariffs | western land grants

D2) civil rights movement | gold rush | early colonial settlement

GED-SOC5-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state legislature has 80 representatives. After an election, 44 representatives support a bill and 36 oppose it.

What percent of representatives support the bill?

- A) 45%
- B) 50%
- C) 55%
- D) 80%

GED-SOC5-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city posts the full text of proposed ordinances before council meetings. The city also records the final vote of each council member. Residents can compare campaign promises with actual votes.

Which claim is best supported by this source?

- A) Public records can help voters evaluate elected officials.
- B) Recorded votes prevent residents from learning about government.
- C) Ordinances are valid only if written by private citizens.
- D) Campaign promises replace the need for lawmaking.

GED-SOC5-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A family can buy a used car with cash or take out a loan for a newer car. The newer car has lower repair costs but would require monthly payments and interest. The family chooses the used car to avoid debt.

Which economic consideration most directly influenced the decision?

- A) The cost of borrowing money
- B) The power of judicial review
- C) The process of naturalization
- D) The location of international borders

GED-SOC5-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1960s and 1970s, several groups organized to demand changes in laws, workplaces, schools, and public policy. Some campaigns focused on women's rights, disability rights, environmental protection, or the rights of Native peoples. These movements often used lawsuits, public demonstrations, and lobbying.

Which broader pattern is shown by the source?

- A) Social movements used multiple methods to seek legal and political change.
- B) Social movements avoided courts and public demonstrations.
- C) Public policy could not be influenced by organized groups.
- D) The period ended all disagreement about rights.

GED-SOC5-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Initiative
- B) Referendum
- C) Recall

D) Lobbying

Targets:

T1) Citizens vote on whether to approve or reject a law already passed or proposed.

T2) Citizens vote on whether to remove an elected official before the term ends.

T3) Individuals or groups try to persuade officials to support a policy.

GED-SOC5-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region contains several countries that share a river system. Upstream dams provide electricity and irrigation, but downstream communities worry that reduced water flow will harm farms and fisheries.

Which issue is most clearly described?

A) Shared natural resources can create cooperation and conflict across borders.

B) Rivers never affect relations among neighboring countries.

C) Dams are built only in areas without farms.

D) Downstream communities always control upstream water use.

GED-SOC5-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city ordinance requires public officials to disclose financial interests related to contracts they vote on. The rule is designed to show whether officials may personally benefit from government decisions.

Which civic goal does this ordinance most directly support?

A) Reducing conflicts of interest

B) Expanding military authority

C) Ending public elections

D) Limiting freedom of religion

GED-SOC5-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A legislature passes a law that names one person guilty of a crime and orders punishment without a trial. A court strikes down the law because legislatures may not declare specific people guilty without judicial proceedings.

Which constitutional protection is most directly involved?

A) Ban on bills of attainder

B) Power of the Senate to approve treaties

- C) Right of states to regulate schools
- D) Power of Congress to create post offices

GED-SOC5-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

After World War I, many Americans debated the country's role in international affairs. Some supported joining an international organization designed to prevent future wars. Others feared that membership might pull the United States into conflicts without enough control by Congress.

Which issue was central to this debate?

- A) Whether international cooperation could threaten national decision-making power
- B) Whether the colonies should declare independence from Britain
- C) Whether railroads should receive western land grants
- D) Whether enslaved people should be counted for representation

GED-SOC5-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A school board election had the following vote totals.

Candidate: Adams, Brooks, Carter

Votes: 2,750, 3,125, 2,625

How many total votes were cast for the three candidates?

- A) 7,500
- B) 8,000
- C) 8,500
- D) 9,250

GED-SOC5-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A resident disagrees with a zoning decision but says, "I will appeal through the process listed in the city code instead of trying to pressure officials outside the law."

Which civic principle is best shown by the resident's response?

- A) Respect for lawful procedures
- B) Rejection of due process
- C) Rule by inherited authority
- D) Refusal to participate in civic life

GED-SOC5-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A county reports how residents submitted public comments on a housing proposal.

Method: Online form, Public meeting, Mail, Phone

Comments: 480, 220, 140, 60

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Online form was the most used method.
- B) Phone comments were the least used method.
- C) Mail comments exceeded public meeting comments.
- D) Public meeting comments totaled 480.
- E) Mail and phone comments together totaled 300.

GED-SOC5-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court decides that a city cannot require people to pay a large fee before holding a peaceful protest in a public park if the fee effectively prevents low-income groups from speaking. The city may charge reasonable costs, but the rules must not unfairly block expression.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Government may regulate public spaces, but rules cannot unfairly burden protected expression.
- B) Government may ban all public protest when it dislikes a message.
- C) Only wealthy groups have the right to assemble.
- D) Courts cannot review rules affecting public demonstrations.

GED-SOC5-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows the number of public high school graduates in one state.

Year: 1950, 1970, 1990

Graduates: 22,000, 58,000, 91,000

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) The number of graduates increased from 1950 to 1990.
- B) The number of graduates decreased after 1950.
- C) The number of graduates was highest in 1950.
- D) The number of graduates stayed the same in each year.

GED-SOC5-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state court explains that government must provide clear rules before enforcing penalties. If a law is so vague that ordinary people cannot understand what conduct is prohibited, the law may lead to unfair or arbitrary enforcement.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Clear laws help protect due process and fair enforcement.
- B) Laws should be secret so people cannot challenge them.
- C) Vague laws always make enforcement more fair.
- D) Courts may not consider whether laws are understandable.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC5-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Equal representation — Explanation: Redistricting with roughly equal populations helps voters have similar representation.

GED-SOC5-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Suppliers offered more loaves as the price increased. — Explanation: The table shows supply rising from 180 to 360 loaves as price rises from \$2 to \$4.

GED-SOC5-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The slavery debate also raised questions about civil liberties and political expression. — Explanation: The source connects abolitionist activity to speech, petition, and political participation.

GED-SOC5-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Mountain environments affect farming, transportation, and trade. — Explanation: The scenario describes steep slopes, terraces, animals, roads, and trade routes shaped by mountain geography.

GED-SOC5-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Residents are providing input before a public spending decision. | Public hearings can help officials learn community concerns. — Explanation: Hearings and comments allow residents to participate before the commission decides on bonds.

GED-SOC5-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether election rules should balance security with access to voting — Explanation: Source A emphasizes election integrity, while Source B emphasizes avoiding unnecessary barriers for eligible voters.

GED-SOC5-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Debate over U.S. imperialism and overseas expansion — Explanation: The source describes disagreement over acquiring overseas territories and ruling people without full consent.

GED-SOC5-008 — Correct: D1=beyond a reasonable doubt; D2=legal counsel — Correct Answer: D1=beyond a reasonable doubt; D2=legal counsel — Explanation: Criminal convictions require proof beyond a reasonable doubt, and the accused has the right to counsel.

GED-SOC5-009 — Correct: 25 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 25 — Explanation: The increase is \$4; \$4 divided by \$16 equals 25%.

GED-SOC5-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Access to transportation networks can influence economic growth and migration. — Explanation: Port investment increases trade-related jobs and draws workers to port cities.

GED-SOC5-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Administrative agencies can carry out laws, but their actions remain subject to legal limits. — Explanation: Agencies enforce laws passed by Congress and can be reviewed by courts.

GED-SOC5-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Aircraft production expanded sharply between 1940 and 1944. — Explanation: Production rose from 6,000 to 96,000 aircraft.

GED-SOC5-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Eminent domain with just compensation — Explanation: Government may take private property for public use only with lawful procedures and fair compensation.

GED-SOC5-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Incentives can influence business decisions. — Explanation: The tax credit lowers costs and encourages companies to invest in equipment.

GED-SOC5-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Protection against ex post facto laws — Explanation: Ex post facto protections prevent punishment under laws that make conduct illegal after it occurred.

GED-SOC5-016 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: Environmental and economic pressures contributed to migration. | The crisis affected both where people lived and how they worked. — Explanation: Drought, erosion, and falling prices pushed families to move and seek new work.

GED-SOC5-017 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Hydropower — Explanation: Natural gas is first at 42%, and hydropower is second at 28%.

GED-SOC5-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public accountability through access to information — Explanation: Access to agency records allows journalists and citizens to examine government spending.

GED-SOC5-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Tourism revenue increased each year. — Explanation: Revenue rose from \$3.2 million to \$3.8 million to \$4.5 million.

GED-SOC5-020 — Correct: D1=racial segregation; D2=civil rights movement — Correct Answer: D1=racial segregation; D2=civil rights movement — Explanation: Brown v. Board of Education challenged racial segregation in public schools and became a major civil rights milestone.

GED-SOC5-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 55% — Explanation: 44 out of 80 representatives supported the bill; $44 \div 80 = 55\%$.

GED-SOC5-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public records can help voters evaluate elected officials. — Explanation: Proposed ordinances and recorded votes allow residents to compare actions with campaign promises.

GED-SOC5-023 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The cost of borrowing money — Explanation: The family avoids the newer car because a loan would require monthly payments and interest.

GED-SOC5-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Social movements used multiple methods to seek legal and political change. — Explanation: The source describes lawsuits, demonstrations, and lobbying used by several movements.

GED-SOC5-025 — Correct: T1=B; T2=C; T3=D — Correct Answer: T1=Referendum; T2=Recall; T3=Lobbying — Explanation: A referendum lets citizens vote on a law, a recall can remove an official, and lobbying tries to persuade officials.

GED-SOC5-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Shared natural resources can create cooperation and conflict across borders. — Explanation: The river system crosses borders, and upstream dams affect downstream communities.

GED-SOC5-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Reducing conflicts of interest — Explanation: Financial disclosure helps reveal when officials may personally benefit from decisions.

GED-SOC5-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Ban on bills of attainder — Explanation: A bill of attainder is a legislative act that punishes a specific person without a trial.

GED-SOC5-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether international cooperation could threaten national decision-making power — Explanation: The debate involved joining an international organization versus protecting congressional control over war decisions.

GED-SOC5-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 8,500 — Explanation: $2,750 + 3,125 + 2,625 = 8,500$.

GED-SOC5-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Respect for lawful procedures — Explanation: The resident chooses to use the appeal process established by law.

GED-SOC5-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Online form was the most used method. | Phone comments were the least used method. — Explanation: Online form has the highest number at 480, and phone has the lowest at 60.

GED-SOC5-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government may regulate public spaces, but rules cannot unfairly burden protected expression. — Explanation: The ruling allows reasonable regulation but not fees that unfairly block protected speech or assembly.

GED-SOC5-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The number of graduates increased from 1950 to 1990. — Explanation: Graduates increased from 22,000 to 58,000 to 91,000.

GED-SOC5-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Clear laws help protect due process and fair enforcement. — Explanation: Clear laws help people understand what is prohibited and limit arbitrary enforcement.